PHISHING EMAIL DETECTION & AWARENESS REPORT

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Tools used: Email Samples, Browser Tools, Email Header Analyzer

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INTRODUCTION

Phishing attacks are one of the most common cybersecurity threats. Attackers use fraudulent emails to trick users into revealing sensitive information such as passwords, banking details, and personal information. This report analyzes phishing email samples and identifies key indicators of phishing attacks.

Why Phishing is Dangerous:

Phishing attacks can lead to data breaches, financial loss, and identity theft. Organizations and individuals must be aware of phishing techniques to prevent cyberattacks and protect sensitive information.

Common Phishing Targets

- Banking users
- Email accounts
- Social media accounts
- Corporate employees
- Online shopping users

OBJECTIVE

The objective of this project is to:

- Identify phishing emails
- Analyze phishing indicators
- Classify emails based on risk
- Provide prevention guidelines
- Raise cybersecurity awareness

TOOLS USED

Tool	Purpose
Email Samples	Phishing analysis
Browser Tools	Link inspection
Email Header Analyzer	Sender verification
Canva	Report creation

TYPES OF PHISHING

Phishing attacks can occur in several different forms. Some of the most common types include:

Email Phishing:
This is the most common form of phishing. Attackers send fraudulent emails to a large number of users hoping that some recipients will fall for the scam.

Spear Phishing:
Spear phishing targets specific individuals or organizations. Attackers often research their victims to make the email appear more convincing.

Whaling:

Whaling is a form of phishing that targets high-level executives or senior employees such as CEOs and managers.

Smishing:

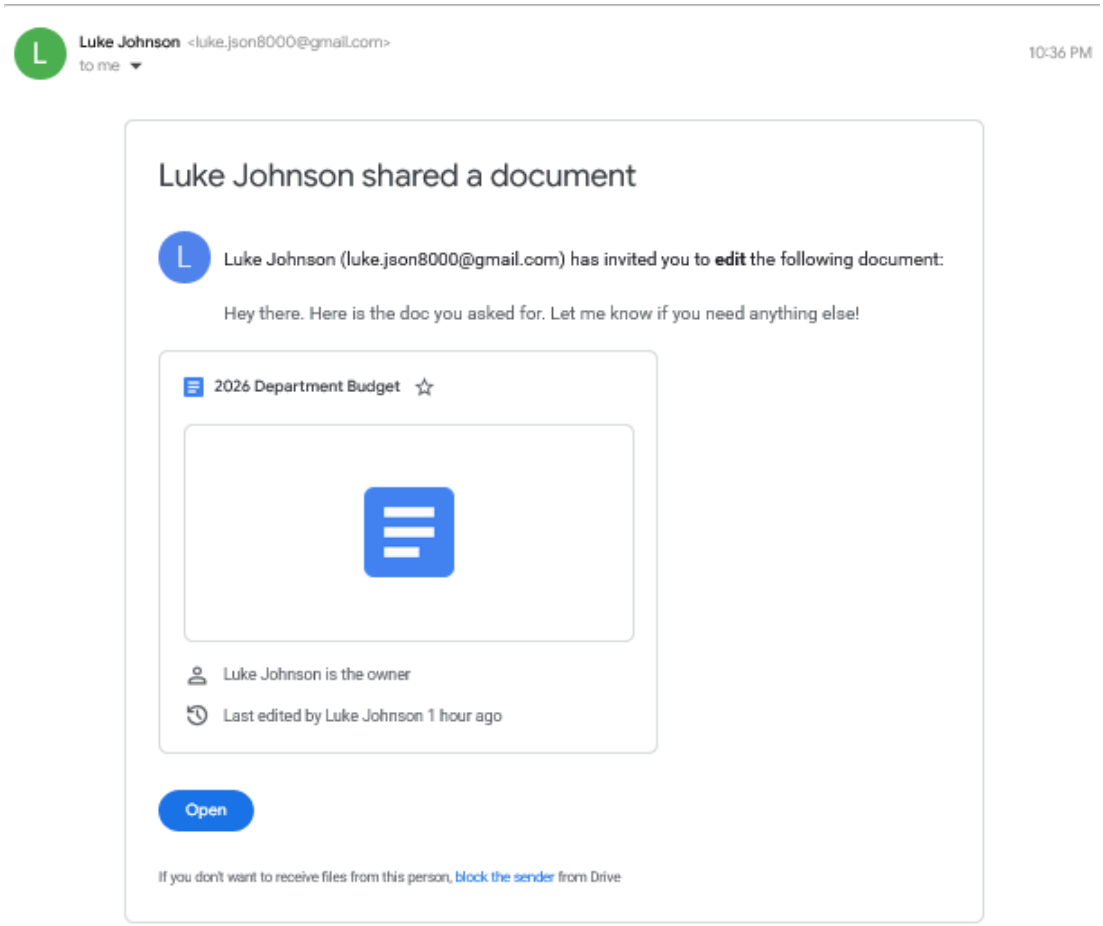
Smishing refers to phishing attacks conducted through SMS or text messages that contain malicious links.

Vishing:

Vishing involves attackers using phone calls to trick victims into revealing sensitive information by pretending to be customer support or bank representatives.

EMAIL ANALYSIS

Example 1 — Fake Document Sharing Phishing Email



Email Type: Phishing
Risk Level: High

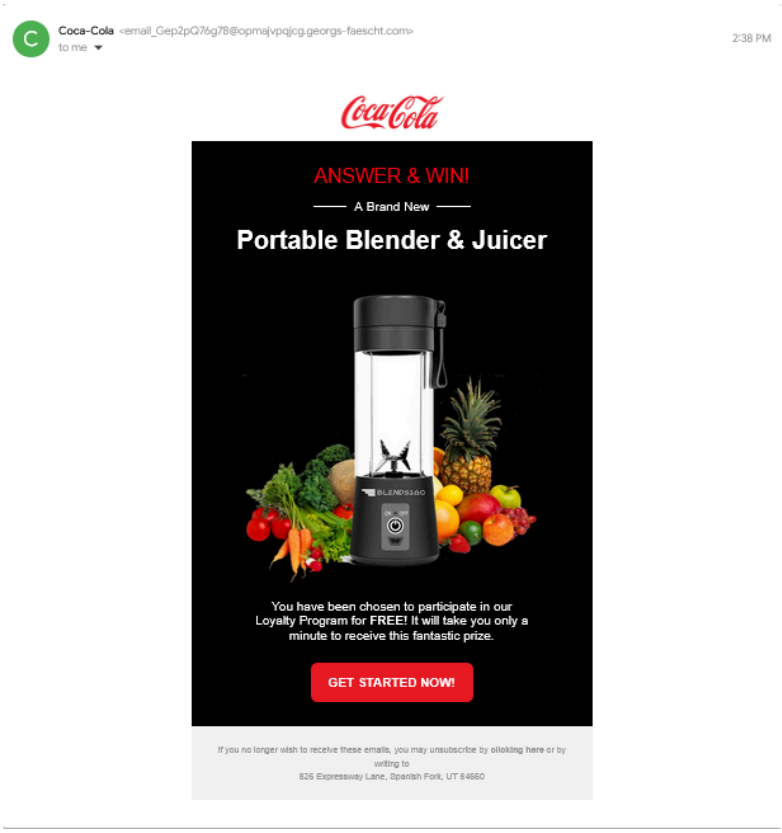
Indicators Identified:

- Unsafe link
- Urgent action (Open button)
- Unknown sender

Explanation:
This email attempts to trick the user into opening a shared document from an unknown sender. Attackers often use fake document-sharing emails to deliver malicious links or steal login credentials.

EMAIL ANALYSIS

Example 2 — Fake Prize Giveaway Phishing Email



Email Type: Prize Giveaway Phishing
Risk Level: High

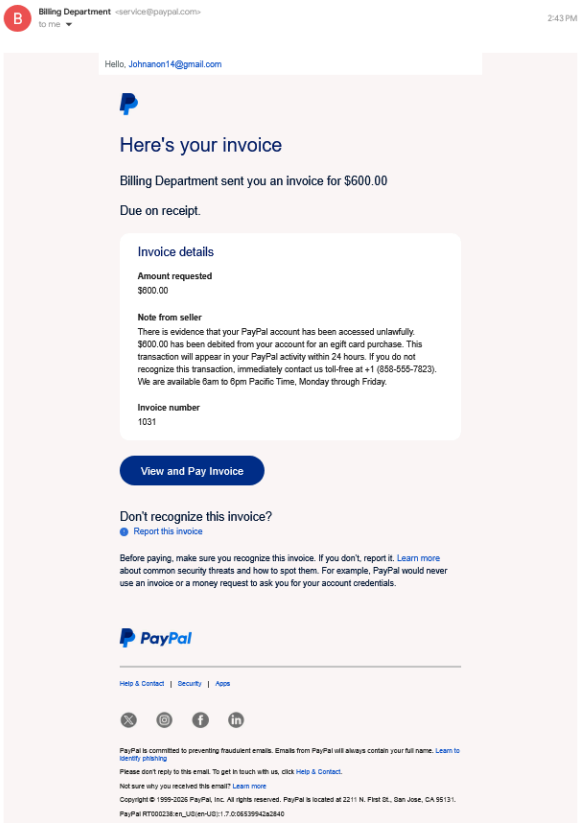
Indicators Identified:

- Suspicious sender email address
- Unexpected prize offer
- Urgent call-to-action ("Get Started Now")
- Unknown loyalty program

Explanation:
This email claims that the user has been selected to win a portable blender and juicer. However, the sender email appears suspicious and does not match the official Coca-Cola domain. Attackers commonly use fake prize emails to trick users into clicking malicious links or providing personal information.

EMAIL ANALYSIS

Example 3 — Fake PayPal Invoice Phishing Email



B Billing Department <service@paypal.com>
to me
2:43 PM

Hello, Johnanon14@gmail.com

Here's your invoice

Billing Department sent you an invoice for $600.00

Due on receipt.

Invoice details

Amount requested
$600.00

Note from seller
There is evidence that your PayPal account has been accessed unlawfully. $600.00 has been debited from your account for an egift card purchase. This transaction will appear in your PayPal activity within 24 hours. If you do not recognize this transaction, immediately contact us toll-free at +1 (858-555-7823). We are available 6am to 6pm Pacific Time, Monday through Friday.

Invoice number
1031

View and Pay Invoice

Don't recognize this invoice?
Report this invoice

Before paying, make sure you recognize this invoice. If you don't, report it. Learn more about common security threats and how to spot them. For example, PayPal would never use an invoice or a money request to ask you for your account credentials.

PayPal

Help & Contact | Security | Apps

PayPal is committed to preventing fraudulent emails. Emails from PayPal will always contain your full name. Learn to identify phishing

Please don't reply to this email. To get in touch with us, click Help & Contact.

Not sure why you received this email? Learn more

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PayPal RT000238:en_US:en-US:1.7.0:0653994a2840

Email Type: Invoice Phishing
Risk Level: High

Indicators Identified

- Suspicious sender ("Billing Department")
- Fear tactic ("account accessed unlawfully")
- Urgent deadline (24 hours)
- Unknown invoice number

Explanation:
This email claims that a PayPal invoice of $600 has been generated due to suspicious account activity. The attacker uses fear tactics to trick users into clicking the "View and Pay Invoice" button. This is a common phishing technique used to steal login credentials or financial information.

PREVENTION TIPS

How to Identify Phishing Emails

- Check sender email address carefully
- Avoid clicking suspicious links
- Look for spelling and grammar mistakes
- Do not download unknown attachments
- Verify unexpected requests
- Be cautious of urgent or threatening messages

CONCLUSION

Phishing attacks are one of the most common cybersecurity threats. Users must stay alert and verify suspicious emails before taking any action. By identifying warning signs and following best practices, users can avoid falling victim to phishing attacks and protect sensitive information.

References:

Google Phishing quiz